

Infrastructure Vision For Headley Farm & Event Center: A Wholehearted Infrastructure Vision

Note: ChatGPT: "Great. I'll begin a deep dive into the layered history of your property and surrounding area, including its ties to Chief Ladiga, the 1832 home's origins, its possible role as a speakeasy for Fort McClellan, and historical developments tied to the fort and land transfer. I'll also explore potential historic designations or preservation grants relevant to properties like yours. I'll let you know when the findings are ready for review."

I. Purpose & Vision

Headley Farm & Event Center is becoming a catalytic, trail-connected, land-rooted gathering place at the northern edge of Anniston. Through infrastructure improvements—utilities, access roads, fencing, and shared-use spaces—we're building a rural innovation node where beauty, business, belonging, and biodiversity meet.

This is more than a flower shop. It's a living classroom, a regenerative hospitality site, and a community gateway connecting the Chief Ladiga Trail to local commerce, culture, and care.

II. Project Components

1. Trail Kiosk + Flower Shop (Phase 1)

- Trailside retail and hospitality space
- Electricity, water, septic or greywater system
- Solar-powered lighting and security
- Community activation space for storytelling, floral bar, art

2. Event Center (Phase 2–3)

- Indoor-outdoor space for weddings, retreats, meals, and music
- Positioned near trail access and guest cabins
- Trail-to-table venue for partner events

3. Tiny House Guest Cabins (Phase 2)

- Hospitality zone along eastern trail edge
- Lodging for wedding guests, volunteers, educators, fellows
- Solar and shared infrastructure-ready

4. Interior Fencing & Irrigation

- NRCS-eligible rotational fencing
- Pollinator corridors and wildflower zones
- Water lines for floral and edible beds, mobile irrigation

5. Access Road (Phase 1–2)

- Connects Hwy 21 commercial zone (Walmart/Tractor Supply) across Ladiga Trail
- Enhances visitor access, safety, and visibility
- Requires city and trail coordination

III. Core Goals

Goal	Outcomes
Trail Activation	Increased trail use, community engagement, safety improvements
Ecotourism + Events	Year-round revenue through weddings, workshops, retreats

Regenerative Education	Youth + adult programs, partnerships with Camp Lee, JSU, homeschool networks
Public-Private Infrastructure	Shared investment with city for long-term ROI
Legacy + Hospitality	Honor the land, your family name, and the people who made it possible

IV. Strategic Partnerships

Partner	Opportunity
Shea Miller / Trail Committee	Trail funding, political bridgebuilding, fundraising leader
City of Anniston (Jackson Hodges / Carla Eden)	Trail crossing, access road, utility co-investment
Coldwater Mountain Brewpub	Trail events, farm-to-table collabs, Clontz legacy
Camp Lee	Youth retreats, land education, leadership intensives
Sinclair Social / Fancy / Ben Miller	Media, donor engagement, story amplification
Called Coffee	Downtown flower bar partner, community anchor
NRCS / USDA	Infrastructure funding, fencing, energy, rural business support

V. Funding Streams & Status

Funding Source	What It Supports	Action Status
NRCS EQIP	Fencing, irrigation, native plantings	Pre-application in planning
USDA REAP & Rural Dev	Solar, infrastructure, event space	Contact local rep
City of Anniston	Trail connector road, utilities, shared marketing	Meeting requested
Tourism / Rec / ALDOT	Trail infrastructure, trailhead hospitality	Identify cycles
Private Donors / Fundraisers	Cabin sponsorship, wildflower trail, road naming	Design campaign

VI. Phased Timeline

Phase	Focus
Phase 1 (Spring–Summer 2025)	Utilities to flower shop & kiosk, trail connector road, fencing
Phase 2 (Fall–Winter 2025)	Tiny houses, irrigation, education partnerships
Phase 3 (2026)	Event center construction, full trail programming, public activations

VII. Visual & Digital Assets (In Progress)

- Site Map Overlay (with zones labeled)
- Trail Partnership Map
- PDF Pitch Deck for City + Funders
- Website + Storytelling Assets (for Clontz legacy, events, and donation campaigns)

VIII. Immediate Next Steps

- Finalize infrastructure bid-ready specs (electric, water, septic)
- Schedule follow-up with Jackson Hodges, Carla Eden, and Shea Miller
- Begin NRCS pre-application for fencing and water access
- Draft funding outreach for Coldwater Brewpub and trail committee
- Storyboard “Wholehearted Gateway” launch event concept (Fall 2025)

Would you like this formatted into a PDF pitch doc or editable Notion/Google Doc?
And shall we continue with outreach scripts, donor packet design, or NRCS application next?